

Samuel David Higbee

Contact Information

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Academic Positions

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

July 2025–present

Education

University of Chicago

Ph.D. in Economics

2025

Brigham Young University

B.S. in Mathematics and Economics

2019

Working Papers

Experimental design for policy choice.

Distributionally robust optimal transport for program evaluation. With Omkar Katta and Guillaume Pouliot.

Published and Accepted Papers

Policy learning with new treatments. *Quantitative Economics* 16, no. 4 (2025): 1409-1456.

Outcome based accountability: Theory and evidence. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* 160 (2019): 121-137. With Lars Lefgren, Brennan Platt and Joseph Price.

Presentations

Econometric Society North American Winter Meeting 2026

Caltech, University of Toronto, Duke, Yale, NYU, UCLA, USC, WashU, UNC Chapel Hill, Class of 2025 Microeconometrics Conference, Penn State, Texas A&M, Princeton, University of Virginia, Dynamic Structural Econometrics Conference 2025

Econometrics Junior Conference, BYU Graduate Student Conference, Chicago Causal Inference Student Conference, Econometric Society North American Winter Meeting 2024

Economics Graduate Student Conference, Optimization-Conscious Econometrics Conference 2023

Delhi School of Economics Winter School, BYU Graduate Student Conference 2022

Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

Rosen Memorial Fellowship	2024-2025
Roswell & Mary McKeon Whitman Scholarship	2024-2025
Martin & Margaret Lee Prize for the microeconomics core exam	2020
University of Chicago Social Sciences Division Fellowship	2019-2024
Thomas S. Monson Presidential Scholarship	2015-2019

Teaching Experience

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (Instructor)	
Econometrics (undergraduate)	2026
University of Chicago (Teaching Assistant)	
Optimization-Conscious Econometrics (PhD)	2023
Econometrics (undergraduate)	2022-2023
Topics on the Analysis of Randomized Experiments (PhD)	2022
Applied Regression Analysis (MBA)	2021
Empirical Analysis III (PhD)	2021

Professional Service

Refereeing

Econometric Theory, Journal of Econometrics

Organizer of Semiparametrics Reading Group, University of Chicago	2023
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